EcoExplorers: Habitats and Species Guide

Literature Day Grade 2 Showcase
Source: EcoExplorers Website

Overview

This reference guide documents the native animal and plant species and their corresponding natural habitats featured across the Class 2A (Haiti), Class 2B (Suriname), and Class 2C (Bolivia) trails of the EcoExplorers educational project.

1. 🇭🇹 Haiti Trail (Class 2A)

1.1 High-Elevation Mountain Pine & Cloud Forest

- **Tagged Species:** Hispaniolan Trogon (*Priotelus roseigaster*), Hispaniolan Pine (*Pinus occidentalis*)
- **Habitat Description:** High-altitude mountain ridges and steep slopes above 1,000 meters elevation shrouded in mist and low clouds. The canopy is dominated by native Hispaniolan pines and tree ferns that capture cloud moisture to nourish mountain rivers. Dead tree trunks ("snags") provide nesting cavities for the Hispaniolan Trogon.



1.2 Arid Limestone Terraces & Coastal Scrub

- **Tagged Species:** Least Pauraque (*Siphonorhis brewsteri*), Oviedo's Cherry Palm (*Pseudophoenix ekmanii*), Bayahibe Rose (*Leuenbergeria quisqueyana*)

- **Habitat Description:** Lowland dry limestone terraces and rocky coastal hillsides. Characterized by porous limestone rock outcrops, dry thorny thickets, bottle-trunk cherry palms, and rare leaf-bearing cacti rooted in rock fissures. The Least Pauraque camouflages directly among the limestone rocks and leaf litter on the ground.



1.3 Dense Moist Forest Floor & Cave Burrows

- **Tagged Species:** Hispaniolan Solenodon (*Solenodon paradoxus*)
- **Habitat Description:** Shaded, humid primary forest with deep, moist soils, thick leaf litter, moss-covered boulders, and subterranean cave formations. This environment protects the underground tunnel networks of the nocturnal, venomous Solenodon.



2. 🇸🇷 Suriname Trail (Class 2B)

2.1 Lowland Tropical Rainforest Canopy & Emergent Trees

- **Tagged Species:** Harpy Eagle (*Harpia harpyja*), Margay (*Leopardus wiedii*)
- **Habitat Description:** Undisturbed lowland tropical rainforest canopy with towering emergent trees (such as kapok/silk-cotton trees) that extend above the main forest ceiling. Thick aerial branches, lianas, and epiphyte mats provide nesting platforms for Harpy Eagles and hunting pathways for arboreal Margays.



2.2 Granite Boulder Outcrops & Cliff Caves

- **Tagged Species:** Guianan Cock-of-the-Rock (*Rupicola rupicola*)
- **Habitat Description:** Humid rainforest terrain defined by massive ancient granite boulders, cliff faces, and sheltered rock caves. The shaded rock overhangs provide nesting sites and lek display grounds for the brightly colored Cock-of-the-Rock.



2.3 White-Sand Forest & Riverbanks (Dakama Forests)

- **Tagged Species:** Clump Wallaba (*Eperua grandiflora*), Sand Baromalli (*Catostemma fragrans*)
- **Habitat Description:** Nutrient-poor, bleached white-sand soils along meandering blackwater rivers and streams. Dominated by resilient Wallaba and Baromalli trees that thrive in acidic, well-drained sandy terrain.



2.4 Misty Plateau Bogs (Tepui Summits)

- **Tagged Species:** Marsh Pitcher Plant (*Heliamphora* spp.)
- **Habitat Description:** High-elevation waterlogged peat bogs and sandstone depressions atop isolated flat-topped tabletop mountains (tepuis) of the Guiana Shield, exposed to constant rain, cloud immersion, and leached acidic soils.



3. 🇧🇴 Bolivia Trail (Class 2C)

3.1 Amazonian Lowland River Basin

- **Tagged Species:** Bolivian River Dolphin (*Inia boliviensis*)
- **Habitat Description:** Sinuous freshwater river channels, sandbars, oxbow lagoons, and seasonally flooded forest banks within the Upper Madeira, Mamoré, and Beni river systems of the Bolivian Amazon lowlands.



3.2 Flooded Savanna & Motacú Palm Islands (Llanos de Moxos)

- **Tagged Species:** Blue-throated Macaw (*Ara glaucogularis*)

- **Habitat Description:** Seasonally inundated wetland grasslands interspersed with elevated forest patches ("islas de bosque") dominated by native motacú palms (*Attalea phalerata*), providing essential nesting cavities and fruit for the macaws.



3.3 Dry Inter-Andean Sandstone Canyons

- **Tagged Species:** Red-fronted Macaw (*Ara rubrogenys*), Golden Rat Tail Cactus (*Cleistocactus winteri*), Cardenasiodendron Tree (*Cardenasiodendron brachypterum*)
- **Habitat Description:** Semi-arid inter-Andean river valleys characterized by sheer red sandstone cliffs, dry scrub woodlands, and vertical cliff walls where trailing cacti cling and macaws nest in rock fissures.



3.4 High Andean Polylepis (Queñua) Forest

- **Tagged Species:** Queñua de Altura (*Polylepis tarapacana*)
- **Habitat Description:** Alpine high-altitude slopes and rocky volcanic scree between 3,500 and 5,000 meters in the freezing Andean Puna. These gnarled, paper-barked dwarf trees form some of the highest-elevation woodlands in the world.

